requests access, it asks for certain scopes, and the resource owner decides whether to approve them.

For example, ACME's Customer Collaboration platform specifies scopes such as these:

- `collab:workspace.read`—read the list of workspaces and memberships.
- `collab:doc.meta.read`—read document metadata (titles, owners, labels, last updated), but not the full content.
- `collab:doc.write`—update document titles or statuses.
- `collab:task.read` and `collab:task.write`—view or update tasks related to documents.
- `collab:event.subscribe`—register for event notifications (such as `task.created` or `document.status_changed`).

When a token is issued, these scopes may be included directly within the token itself (as a claim in a self-contained JWT) or stored on the server and returned during token introspection. In ACME's system, scopes are encoded in the access token, allowing the API gateway to read them immediately after validating the token. In either case, scopes serve as a broad filter: they determine which APIs a client can attempt to call. Cedar policies then overlay this, enforcing fine-grained rules about specific resources and actions that are permitted.